Installing Multilingo – step by step

jm-berlin.github.io/multilingo

Multilingo is a **web app** (PWA). There is no installer to download: you open the address once in your browser and add the app from there. After that Multilingo has its own icon, opens without the browser bar and also works **offline**.

Address: https://jm-berlin.github.io/multilingo/

1. Add the app

iPhone and iPad (Safari)

1. Open **Safari** (not Chrome) and go to the address above.
2. Wait until the start page has fully loaded.
3. Tap the **Share icon** (square with an arrow pointing up). On iPhone it is at the bottom, on iPad at the top right.
4. Scroll down the list and tap **“Add to Home Screen”**.
5. The name “Multilingo” is already filled in. Tap **“Add”** at the top right.
6. The Multilingo icon appears on your home screen. From now on, start the app from there.

Android (Chrome)

1. Open **Chrome** and go to the address above.
2. Often a prompt **“Install Multilingo”** appears at the bottom. Tap it and confirm with **“Install”**.
3. If no prompt appears: tap the **menu** ⋮ at the top right → **“Install app”** (on some devices “Add to Home screen”).
4. The icon appears on your home screen and in the app drawer.

Windows and Mac (Chrome or Microsoft Edge)

1. Open **Chrome** or **Edge** and go to the address above.
2. Click the **install icon** on the right of the address bar (a screen with an arrow or plus).
3. Alternatively in Chrome: **menu** ⋮ → **“Cast, save and share”** → **“Install page as app …”**
4. In Edge: **menu …** → **“Apps”** → **“Install this site as an app”**
5. Confirm with **“Install”**.
6. Multilingo opens in its own window and appears in the Start menu (Windows) or in the Applications folder and Dock (Mac).

Mac (Safari, macOS Sonoma or later)

1. Open the address in **Safari**.
2. Menu **“File”** → **“Add to Dock …”** → **“Add”**.

Firefox cannot install web apps on desktop. You can still use Multilingo normally in the browser there, or use Chrome, Edge or Safari to install it.

2. First start

1. **Choose your source language:** If a window “Which language do you speak?” appears, tap your language. You can change it later under ⚙. If no window appears, Multilingo starts in German.
2. **Language packs:** On first start Multilingo downloads German, English, French, Italian and Spanish. Depending on your connection this takes a few seconds (about 2–3 MB in total). Please stay online meanwhile.
3. Done. From now on everything also works **without internet**: the table, pronunciation (using your device’s voices), quiz, grammar, menu and cheat sheet.

3. Add more languages

1. Tap ⚙ at the top → **“App, Sprachpakete & Sicherung”** (app, language packs & backup).
2. Under **Sprachpakete** you see all available languages. “Standard” ones are already installed, “optional” ones can be added.
3. Tap **“Laden”** (load) next to a language. It is immediately available in the table, quiz, grammar and menu.
4. **“Entfernen”** (remove) frees the storage again. Your own entries are kept.

4. Back up your own entries (recommended)

Your own entries and changes are stored **only on this device**. To take them to a new device:

1. ⚙ → **“App, Sprachpakete & Sicherung”** → **“Sicherung herunterladen”** (download backup).
2. Save the file, e.g. in iCloud, Google Drive or OneDrive.
3. On the other device: install Multilingo → ⚙ → **“Sicherung einlesen”** (restore backup) → choose the file.

Multilingo reminds you automatically: once you have entries of your own, a notice with **“Jetzt sichern”** (back up now) appears after 14 days without a backup (and every 30 days after that).

Important: Clearing the normal browser cache is harmless. **Clearing “site data” / “cookies and other site data”**, however, also removes your own entries. Back up first!

5. Translating new words (optional)

Out of the box Multilingo uses everything contained in the language packs. For **new words of your own** the app needs your own **Claude API key**:

1. Create a key at https://console.anthropic.com/settings/keys (requires an Anthropic account with credit).
2. In Multilingo: ⚙ → **“App, Sprachpakete & Sicherung”** → **“Online-Übersetzung”** → paste the key → save.
3. The key stays on your device only. A new entry costs a fraction of a cent.

6. Updates

Updates arrive automatically: every time Multilingo starts with an internet connection, it checks for a new version or new language packs and downloads only what has changed. To check manually: ⚙ → **“Nach Updates suchen”** (check for updates).

7. Uninstall

- **iPhone/iPad:** long-press the icon → “Remove App”.
- **Android:** long-press the icon → “Uninstall”.
- **Windows/Mac (Chrome/Edge):** open the app → menu ⋮ at the top right → “Uninstall Multilingo”.

Download a backup first if you want to keep your own entries.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
No “Add to Home Screen” on iPhone	The page must be opened in **Safari**, not in Chrome or another app.
No install icon on the computer	Use Chrome or Edge. If Multilingo is already installed, the button says “Open in app” instead.
No pronunciation	No voice for that language is installed on the device. Add voices in your device’s language settings.
A language pack does not load	Check your internet connection and tap “Laden” again under ⚙.